PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Phrasing/Pausing

Rules:

The best places to pause in speech are the same as in reading.

- When you see a punctuation mark (comma, period, etc.)
- When you see a conjunction (words like 'and,' 'but,' 'or,' etc.)
- When you see a preposition (words like 'on,' 'in,' 'around,' 'at,' etc.)

I went to work on my computer but then realized it was not working.
[I went to work on my **computer**] *PAUSE* [but then realized it was not **working**].

She went outside, grabbed a huge rake, and started to clean up the yard.
[She went **outside**], *PAUSE* [grabbed a huge **rake**], *PAUSE* [and started to clean up the **yard**].

It makes our brain feel good or comfortable when we can organize something with meaning. Here's an example below with pauses in "unnatural" locations. Notice how it doesn't "feel right."

[She went outside grabbed] *PAUSE* [a huge rake, and started to clean up] *PAUSE* [the yard].

Practice:

Let's do some practice placing pauses in a natural location. The brackets have been placed in each sentence to see a good spot to pause. You might find a better place to pause that feels better for you, and that is fine! Decide for yourself what feels like the right place to pause.

[Excuse me,] [where's the bathroom?]

[Now that I think about it,] [I think I changed my mind.] [I like the second one.]

[He didn't say so specifically,] [but I think he's going to be looking for a new job.]

[They bought a new place] [and will probably move in next month.]

[I ordered the chicken,] [but now that I see your pasta,] [I wish I picked that instead.]

[You'll have to pick up the kids after school,] [I have a meeting scheduled.]

[Our dining room has a table,] [a few simple chairs,] [and a lamp in the corner.]

[I bought a burger,] [fries,] [and a milkshake for lunch.]

[The weather is way too cold] [so I'm not going outside.]

[I went to the store to get groceries,] [but then I realized] [I forgot my wallet.]